



Bete Yared Sunday School

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Comprehensive Administration Manual, Attendance Engine Rules
& Encoder Operational Guidelines

 Bilingual (English & አማርኛ)

 Ethiopian Dual-Time Engine

 Locked Finalized Attendance

 3-Absent Urgent Alerts

 Automatic Sibling Grouping

 Cross-Category Makeups

1. System Overview & Core Capabilities

The **Bete Yared Sunday School Attendance & Student Management System** is a cloud-ready platform tailored to automate attendance taking, maintain clean student directories, streamline family/sibling pastoral care, and prevent dropouts through real-time attendance alerts.

Role Integrity & Scoped Access

Two distinct user levels ensure maximum data security. **Administrators** oversee scheduling, student records, and reports, while **Encoders** have access limited strictly to the sessions assigned to them.

Draft vs. Finalized Locking

Encoders can save in-progress sessions as **Drafts**. Once **Finalized**, the session is securely locked against further edits to preserve audit compliance.

Ethiopian Dual-Time Support

Built-in Ethiopian time conversion bridges international standard time and traditional parish hours (e.g., 09:00 - 11:00 EAT automatically renders as ከጠዋቱ 3:00 - 5:00 ሰዓት).

Cross-Category Makeup Classes

Students attending make-up sessions in another grade are recorded with a *Cross-Category* badge, disabling duplicate marking in their home class and crediting their attendance.

2. Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) Matrix

FEATURE / PERMISSION	ADMINISTRATOR (አስተዳዳሪ)	ATTENDANCE ENCODER (መዝጋቢ)
Dashboard & Statistical Reports	FULL ACCESS	SUMMARY VIEW
Student Registration & Profile Editing	FULL CONTROL	READ-ONLY
Family & Sibling Directory	FULL ACCESS	HIDDEN
Excel / CSV Bulk Student Import	FULL ACCESS	HIDDEN
Create Sessions & Recurring Series	FULL CONTROL	NO
Assign Multiple Encoders to Sessions	FULL CONTROL	NO
Edit Upcoming Sessions (session_date ≥ today)	YES (UPCOMING ONLY)	NO
Edit Past Sessions (Historical integrity)	LOCKED	LOCKED
Record Attendance for Assigned Sessions	ALL SESSIONS	ASSIGNED ONLY
Save Temporary Attendance Drafts	YES	YES
Finalize & Lock Attendance Sheet	YES	YES
Modify Finalized Attendance	AUTHORIZED EDIT	LOCKED
3-Consecutive-Absent Alerts & Direct Dial	ACTIVE MONITOR	NO
Category Matrix & Excel Export	FULL EXPORT	NO
User Account Creation & Password Resets	FULL CONTROL	OWN PASSWORD ONLY

3. Detailed Module Specifications

3.1 Student Management & Family Sibling Grouping

The student registry captures 10 distinct attributes per student: First Name, Father's Name, Mother's Name, Christian (Baptismal) Name, Age, Primary Phone, Emergency / Guardian Contact, Profession/School, Previous Church Service, and Category.

Automated Sibling Grouping Algorithm

The system executes an automated match across father_name and mother_name. Siblings attending different departments (e.g. one in Child, one in Grade 5, and one in Youth) are organized under a single household banner in the **Families** directory, allowing holistic pastoral coordination.

3.2 Session Scheduling & Recurrence Engine

Flexible Recurrence Series

Schedule once, or generate weekly/monthly batches (4, 8, 12, 16, or 24 weeks). The system verifies that no schedule overlap occurs in the same category.

1-Click Continue / Copy Session

Easily duplicate a prior session to next week (+7 days) or next month (+1 month) with all encoders and topics pre-filled.

3.3 Attendance Recording & Locking Rules

Present (ᐃᐅᐅᐅ)

Student physically attended the session.

Absent (ᐅᐅ)

Student missed class without excuse.

Permission (ᐅᐅᐅ)

Official leave/excuse with remarks.

Data Integrity Safeguards

- **Future Date Block:** Attendance cannot be marked prior to the actual session date.
- **Finalized Lock:** Finalized attendance is locked for encoders. Only Administrators can adjust locked records.
- **Upcoming-Only Session Edit:** Session details and assigned encoders can only be modified for upcoming dates (`session_date ≥ today`).

3.4 Cross-Category Attendance Workflow

When a student takes a make-up class in another category:

- 1 **Add to Active Sheet:** The encoder clicks "+ Add Student from Other Category", searches the student's name, and adds them.
- 2 **Cross-Category Badge:** The student is marked Present with an amber "Cross-Category" label.
- 3 **Home Category Disabled State:** In their home category sheet on that same date, their entry is disabled and tagged "Attended in other class", preventing duplicate marking.

3.5 3-Consecutive Absent Urgent Alerts

A real-time sliding window scans historical records per category. When a student misses **3 consecutive sessions** in their home category without an excused cross-attendance:

Immediate Action Triggers:

The **3-Absent Alerts** tab displays their profile, last present date, total absences, and provides two 1-click dial buttons: **Call Student** and **Call Emergency Contact** for instant pastoral outreach.

4. Step-by-Step User Manual

A. User Guide for Attendance Encoders (መዝጋቢዎች)

- 1 Login to Portal:** Enter your encoder username and password.
 - 2 Find Assigned Session:** Navigate to the **Sessions (የትምህርት ክፍለ-ጊዜያት)** tab. Sessions assigned to you will feature a green "Assigned to You" badge.
 - 3 Open Attendance Form:** Click **Take Attendance (መገኘት መዝግብ)**.
 - 4 Mark Attendance:** Use **Mark All Present** for quick bulk marking, or select individual status pills for each student. Add notes for permissions.
 - 5 Save Draft vs. Finalize:**
 - Click **Save Draft** if class is still ongoing and you need to finish later.
 - Click **Finalize & Save** once complete to lock the attendance record.
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B. User Guide for System Administrators (አስተዳዳሪዎች)

- 1 Registering New Students:**
Go to **Students** → click "**+ Register New Student**" → Fill in student and parental details → Click **Save**.
 - 2 Scheduling a Class & Assigning Encoders:**
Go to **Sessions** → click "**+ Create New Session**" → Fill title, date, start/end time (Ethiopian time preview updates automatically) → Check one or more encoders in the **Assigned Encoders** checklist → Choose optional recurrence (e.g., Weekly 12 weeks) → Click **Create**.
 - 3 Editing Upcoming Sessions & Re-assigning Encoders:**
Click the **Edit (✎)** icon on any upcoming session → Adjust title, time, or check/uncheck encoders → Click **Save Changes**.
 - 4 Managing 3-Absent Alerts:**
Open the **3-Absent Alerts** tab → Review flagged students → Click **Call Student** or **Call Emergency** for immediate telephone outreach.
 - 5 Exporting Category Matrix Reports:**
Open **Category Matrix & Export** → Select Category filter → Click **Export to Excel** for parish reporting.
 - 6 Bulk Importing Students from Excel:**
Go to **Category Matrix & Export** → click "**Import from Excel/CSV**" → Download the template → Fill in your data → Upload & confirm the pre-validation table.
 - 7 User Management:**
Go to **User Management** to create new Encoder accounts or reset forgotten passwords.
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